CLC STRIDERS RUNNING CLUB

ANTI-BULLYING POLICY

Statement of intent

CLC Striders Running Club is committed to providing a welcoming, inclusive, respectful and safe environment for all members, where everyone feels valued, supported and able to participate in athletics without fear of bullying, harassment or discrimination.

Bullying is unacceptable in any form and will not be tolerated. The Club is committed to preventing bullying and responding promptly and appropriately to any concerns raised.

This policy applies to all forms of bullying, including face-to-face, online and electronic communication.

All members, coaches, volunteers, officials and committee members share responsibility for creating a positive club environment and challenging unacceptable behaviour.

Anyone who experiences, witnesses or becomes aware of bullying is encouraged to report their concerns to the Club Welfare Officer, a Committee member, the relevant event organiser or England Athletics.

Reports will be handled sensitively and confidentially wherever possible, although information may need to be shared when safeguarding concerns or formal investigations arise.

What is Bullying?

Bullying is behaviour that is intended to cause harm, distress, fear or humiliation, or which has that effect, and is often repeated over time.

Bullying can occur between individuals or groups and can take many forms, including:

- Physical bullying - hitting, kicking, pushing, damaging property or any unwanted physical contact.
- Verbal bullying - name-calling, insults, threats, intimidation or offensive comments.
- Non-verbal bullying - offensive gestures, hostile looks or inappropriate messages.
- Emotional or psychological bullying - humiliating, isolating, undermining, controlling or manipulating another person.
- Social bullying - spreading rumours, excluding individuals or encouraging others to reject or isolate someone.
- Harassment - unwanted behaviour that violates a person's dignity or creates an intimidating, hostile, degrading or offensive environment.

Bullying may be motivated by prejudice or discrimination relating to protected characteristics or personal circumstances, including:

- Race or ethnicity
- Religion or belief
- Sex or gender
- Sexual orientation
- Gender reassignment

- Disability
- Age
- Appearance or personal circumstances

Some forms of bullying may also constitute hate incidents or criminal offences.

What is Cyber Bullying?

Cyber bullying is bullying that takes place through digital technology, including social media platforms, messaging services, online forums, email, websites and mobile devices.

Examples include:

- Sending intimidating, threatening or abusive messages.
- Posting harmful, offensive or humiliating comments online.
- Sharing rumours, private information, photographs or videos without consent.
- Creating fake accounts or impersonating another person.
- Excluding individuals from online groups or communities.
- Sharing discriminatory, hateful or inappropriate content.

Examples within a sporting environment could include:

- A member posting derogatory comments about another member online.
- A coach or volunteer using messaging services to send inappropriate, intimidating or abusive communications.
- Repeated online criticism intended to humiliate or undermine another person.

Cyber bullying can be particularly harmful because:

- It can occur at any time and in any place.
- Content can be shared rapidly and widely.
- Material may remain accessible for long periods.
- Victims may feel unable to escape the behaviour.
- Harmful messages or content can be viewed repeatedly, increasing their impact.

The Club takes cyber bullying as seriously as any other form of bullying and will investigate and respond to concerns in accordance with its disciplinary, welfare and safeguarding procedures.

Reporting Bullying

Any member who experiences, witnesses or suspects bullying should report the matter as soon as possible to the Club Welfare Officer or a member of the Committee.

All reports will be taken seriously and dealt with fairly, promptly and in accordance with the Club's welfare, safeguarding and disciplinary procedures. No person will be disadvantaged for raising a genuine concern in good faith.

Related policies and procedures

- Club Constitution
- Safeguarding Policy
- Codes of Conduct
- Club Grievance and Disciplinary Policy
- Club Inclusion Policy
- Club Social Media Policy

Useful contacts

- Matt Ashman or Amelia Mullins
- UKA 07920 532552/ safeguarding@uka.org.uk
- EA welfare@englandathletics.org

- NSPCC Helpline 0808 800 5000
- Childline 0800 1111 / www.childline.org.uk
- Kidscape www.kidscape.org.uk
- Anti-Bullying Alliance www.antibullyingalliance.org

Updated and approved by the CLC Striders Chair – 8 November 2026